Iasonas Kakandris

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Professional Experience

Software Engineer, IIT, NCSR "Demokritos", Greece — Feb 2026 – Present

- Integrated OpenBao into Themelio for dynamic, short-lived credentials and per-role access, replacing static shared secrets and enabling finer-grained authorization between developers.
- Built zone-based network isolation on the Kubernetes cluster using Calico GlobalNetworkPolicy, containing the blast radius of any service compromise.
- Deployed Open OnDemand on Rocky Linux 9 with Keycloak OIDC, exposing Jupyter, VSCode, and RStudio as Apptainer-based interactive HPC apps.
- Stood up Outline, Keycloak, Zammad, and Plane as the team's documentation, auth, support, and project-tracking stack including a three-layer Zammad helpdesk with custom fields, SLAs, and OIDC integration.
- Migrated infra provisioning and deployment to Ansible, Terraform, and ArgoCD, making cluster and VM state version-controlled and reproducible instead of manually configured.

MLOps Engineer (formerly ML Engineer Intern), ICS, FORTH, Greece — July 2025 – Feb 2026

- Trained a semantic segmentation model for river region detection, achieving a Dice score of 0.91.
- Deployed containerized data pipeline on Kubernetes integrating Kafka, MinIO, PostgreSQL, and Grafana dashboards for live metrics.

Software Engineer Intern, Technology Without Borders, Greece — July 2024 – Sept 2024

- Created customized B2B apps using Microsoft PowerApps, reducing processing time by 98%.
- Designed an event management app using Flutter and Dart with real-time tracking and cloud integration.
- Built a Chrome extension using Plasmo and Firebase for a cross-platform reminders app.

Software Engineer, SpaceDot (student space team), Greece — Nov 2021 – Nov 2024

- Built and containerized the Angular operator UI for monitoring and controlling the team's satellite data transmission system, cutting deployment time by 40%.

Key Skills

Languages: Python, C++, Java, TypeScript, Dart, C, Bash

Backend & Data: Kafka, Quix Streams, River, PostgreSQL, MinIO, Firebase

DevOps & Security: Docker, Kubernetes, k3s, Istio, ArgoCD, Kyverno, Helm, OpenTofu, Ansible, Falco, Trivy, cosign, Slurm, Apptainer, Traefik

Identity & Observability: Authentik, Keycloak, OpenLDAP, SSSD, ColdFront, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Kiali, Zammad

Education

Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (AUTh), Thessaloniki, Greece — Sept 2019 – Dec 2025
M.Eng in Electrical and Computer Engineering (integrated masters; 300 ECTS)

- **Grade**: 8.14/10
- **Major:** Electronics and Computers
- **Thesis:** Design and implementation of a textual domain language to produce machine learning applications on data streams
  - Developed a declarative DSL using TextX and Jinja for streaming ML pipelines.
  - Integrated Kafka, Quix Streams, and River for real-time data ingestion and online learning.

Personal Projects

Self-Hosted Homelab: Operate a self-hosted platform with 20+ Dockerized services, using Traefik for reverse proxying and Cloudflare DNS for secure subdomain routing.

SixPath: Self-hosted professional-network visualization tool that maps and maintains personal connections through an interactive graph interface.